

ZURZUVAE®

(zuranolone)

A 14-Day Treatment for Postpartum Depression

Women's Specialists of Clear Lake · Geoffrey H. Klein, MD, FACOG, DABOM · Patient Education · April 2026

What Is ZURZUVAE?

ZURZUVAE is a prescription medication used to treat **postpartum depression (PPD)** in adults. It is taken for **14 days only**. After completing the 2-week course, no further dosing is required. Some patients may notice improvement in symptoms as early as **Day 3**, with continued improvement over the treatment course.

Who Is It For?

ZURZUVAE is approved for adults diagnosed with postpartum depression, including those whose symptoms began:

- During the **third trimester**
- Within **4 weeks after delivery**

Your healthcare provider will determine if this medication is appropriate for you.

How Is It Taken?

- Taken **once daily in the evening**
- Continue for **14 days total**
- Take **exactly as prescribed**

If you miss a dose, follow your prescriber's instructions.

⚠ **IMPORTANT: Driving Warning (Boxed Warning)**

ZURZUVAE can cause **sleepiness and slow reaction time**.

- Do **not drive** or operate heavy machinery for at least **12 hours** after each dose
- This restriction applies for the **entire 14-day treatment period**
- You may not be able to tell if you are impaired

Plan ahead for childcare, transportation, and work responsibilities during treatment.

Common Side Effects

- Sleepiness (somnolence)
- Dizziness
- Fatigue
- Diarrhea
- Common cold symptoms
- Urinary tract infection

Contact your healthcare provider if side effects are severe or concerning.

CNS Depression

ZURZUVAE may cause:

- Sleepiness or confusion
- Dizziness or balance problems
- Increased risk of falls

Tell your provider if you take alcohol, benzodiazepines, opioids, or other sedating medications.

⚠ **Suicidal Thoughts or Worsening Depression**

Monitor for:

- New or worsening depression
- Suicidal thoughts
- Unusual behavior changes

Seek medical attention immediately if these occur.

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Pregnancy and Birth Control

- ZURZUVAE **may cause harm** to a developing fetus.
- Use **effective contraception** during treatment and for **1 week** after your last dose.
- Tell your provider if you are pregnant or planning pregnancy.

A pregnancy registry is available for women exposed during pregnancy.

Breastfeeding

ZURZUVAE passes into breast milk in low amounts. Discuss with your provider:

- Benefits of breastfeeding
- Your need for treatment
- Potential risks to your infant

Liver or Kidney Problems

If you have significant liver or kidney disease, your provider may prescribe a **lower dose**.

Abuse and Dependence

ZURZUVAE is a **Schedule IV controlled substance**. It has potential for misuse or dependence.

- Take only as prescribed
- Do not share your medication

When to Call Your Provider

Contact your healthcare provider if you experience:

- **Severe drowsiness or confusion**
- **Difficulty staying awake**
- **Worsening mood**
- **Thoughts of self-harm**
- **Severe dizziness or falls**

You Are Not Alone

Postpartum depression is **common and treatable**. ZURZUVAE offers a short, 14-day treatment option that may help relieve symptoms quickly. If you have questions about whether this medication is right for you, please discuss them with your healthcare provider.

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This pamphlet is for informational purposes only and does not replace medical advice from your healthcare provider. Please refer to the full Prescribing Information for ZURZUVAE or speak with your provider for complete details.

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